

Remotion + Claude Code Setup Guide

Your 5-Phase Guide to Building Animated Videos with AI

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Phase 1: Create Your Remotion Project

In your terminal, run ``npx create-video@latest``. Choose the blank template and name your project. This scaffolds the full Remotion folder structure — compositions, public assets, and a sample component ready to edit.

💡 QUICK TIPS

- Use the blank template — it is easier for Claude to work from a clean slate
- Give the project a short kebab-case name like ``my-video`` for easy CLI use

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Phase 2: Open in Antigravity IDE

Open Antigravity and point it at your new Remotion project folder. Claude Code will scan the project automatically and understand the composition structure. Your `CLAUDE.md` should tell it the output format (9:16, 1080x1920) and any brand rules.

💡 QUICK TIPS

- Add a `CLAUDE.md` in the root with: frame size, font preferences, and brand colors
- Install the Remotion VS Code extension if you want inline preview — Antigravity supports it

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Phase 3: Prompt Claude Code to Build

In the Claude Code chat, describe your video in plain English. Claude writes the React component, hooks it into your composition, and updates the timeline. You do not need to touch the code manually — just review and iterate.

💡 QUICK TIPS

- Be specific: mention font size, position (top/center/bottom), and animation style
- Ask Claude to add a ``useCurrentFrame()`` hook for frame-synced captions

Phase 4: Preview and Render

Run ``npx remotion preview`` to open the browser preview server. Scrub through your composition, make notes, and ask Claude to adjust. When it looks right, render the final MP4 with ``npx remotion render MyComposition out/video.mp4``.

💡 QUICK TIPS

- The preview server hot-reloads on every save — no refresh needed
- Use ``--codec h264`` flag for the smallest file size compatible with Instagram and TikTok

Phase 5: Save as a Claude Code Skill

Once the video workflow is working, save it as a skill file in your ``.claude/skills/`` folder. A skill is a reusable instruction set — next time, Claude runs the entire Remotion build from a single command with no manual setup.

💡 QUICK TIPS

- Name the skill file after what it does: ``remotion-caption-video.md``
- Reference your composition name and output path inside the skill so Claude knows where to save renders

Ready to go deeper?

Ready to build a full video pipeline that runs itself? The YouTube Repurposer takes this further — turning any video into captions, thumbnails, and short clips automatically.

Go Deeper: Build Your Video Pipeline →

<https://builds.digicuratoragency.com/youtube-repurposer/>